What sets the MutantXL closure degree: not N; ℓ = 7 or m·ℓ ≥ 21 remain

These are the results of `research/dreg_closure_driver_20261016/`. The full text is in `RESULTS.md`. **Class:** stage diagnostic. The `n = 131` statements are **derived**.

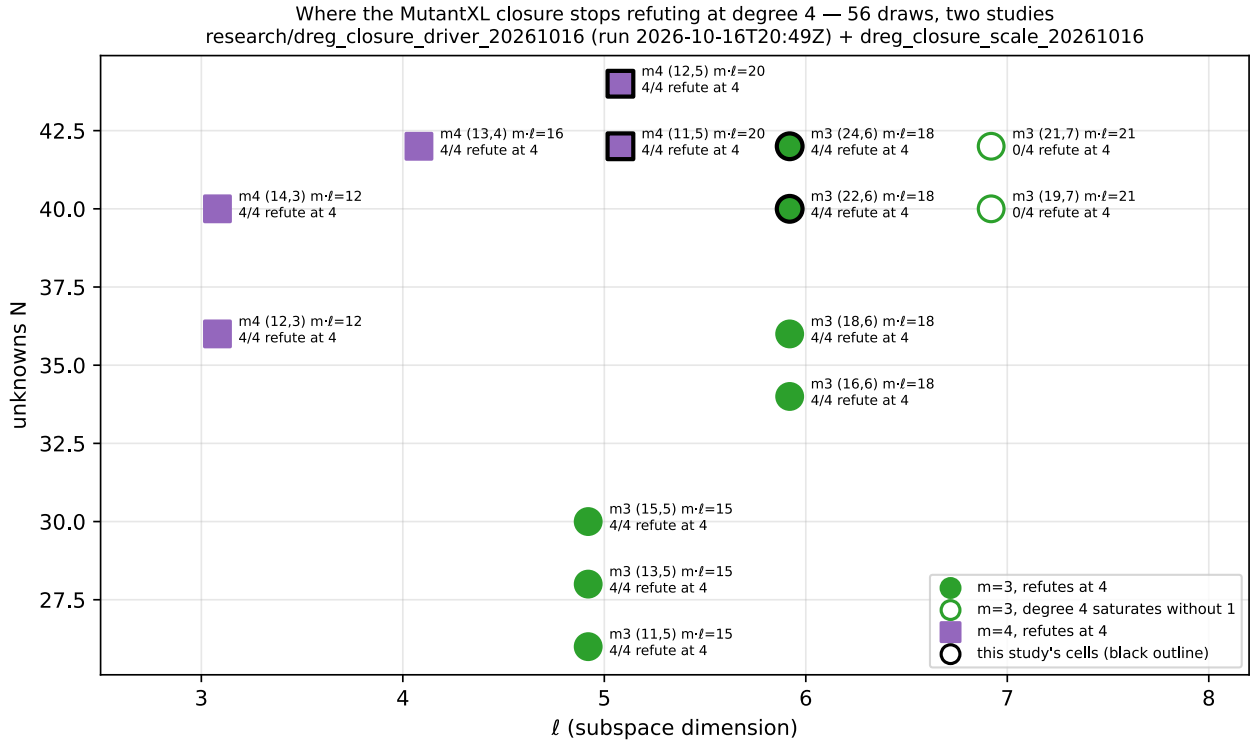


Figure 1: 56 unsatisfiable draws over two studies, placed by (ℓ, N). This study's four cells (16 draws) are outlined in black.

Prediction	outcome	confidence
Q7: m = 3, ℓ = 6 refutes at 4 at N = 40, 42	**holds**: 8 of 8	about 70%
Q8: m = 4, m·ℓ = 20 rises past 4	**refuted**: 8 of 8 refute at 4	about 50%

- **N:** rejected.
- **m·ℓ with a threshold ≤ 20:** rejected.
- **Surviving explanations:** the degree rises at ℓ = 7, or once m·ℓ ≥ 21. Both fit all 56 draws.
- **ECC2K-130 (derived):** both surviving explanations put the m = 4 rise at ℓ = 6 or 7, far below the priced ℓ = 33. The m = 4 "4, constant" row (2^68.43) is therefore contradicted, and the degree-5 rows (m = 4 at 2^71.13) become the optimistic case.
- **Next:** m = 4, ℓ = 6 separates the two survivors, and degree 5 past ℓ = 7 decides the rows. Both need more memory or a sparse closure.